Blueprint roadmap: map out student clubs, marketplace, study abroad, and social feeds into a complete campus platform architecture spec

Computer
Entity-relationship data model: student clubs, marketplace listings, study abroad applications, and campus social feeds in one architecture spec
Computer
Detail the study-abroad application tracker workflow
Build the club event management and RSVP workflow spec
Specify the marketplace listing creation and moderation flow
Artifacts
18
Sources
301

Semester Campus should be designed as a connected **campus life platform** with four major systems working together: marketplace, clubs and events, study-abroad operations, and a social/feed layer. Existing student-engagement systems commonly combine organization management, rosters, RSVPs, event tracking, and communications, while privacy guidance requires careful separation between community activity and protected academic records.[1] [2] [3]

Platform architecture

The architecture should separate domain modules while sharing identity, permissions, search, notifications, moderation, and analytics.

Domain	Core purpose	Primary records
Marketplace	Publish and discover campus opportunities	Listings, providers, applications, moderation reviews
Clubs and events	Manage organizations, rosters, applications, events, and attendance	Organizations, memberships, roles, events, RSVPs
Study abroad	Run program discovery, applications, review, and pre-departure workflows	Programs, terms, applications, documents, decisions
Social and messaging	Support community feeds, group spaces, and real-time messaging	Posts, follows, communities, conversations, reports
Shared services	Identity, authorization, moderation, search, file upload, notifications	Users, roles, files, audit events, preferences

A core product rule should be that academic records and social/community records are not treated as one dataset. FERPA guidance emphasizes that institutions must protect student-record information and limit inappropriate disclosure. [3] [4]

Study-abroad application tracker

Study-abroad portals should function as guided workflow systems rather than simple forms. Institutional and provider processes commonly include submission, document collection, review, nomination or approval, and final commitment steps. [5] [6] [7]

Student workflow

```
Discover program
  → Save / compare
  → Start application
  → Complete profile + essays + documents
  → Submit
  → Eligibility review
  → Staff review / nomination
  → External provider step, if applicable
  → Decision
  → Commit or withdraw
  → Pre-departure requirements
  → Active participant / completed
```

Detailed states

State	Student view	Staff actions
Draft	In-progress checklist, missing items, save-and-resume	No decision actions yet
Submitted	Timestamp, locked/partially locked sections, review queue status	Initial completeness and eligibility check
In eligibility review	Visible “under review” status	GPA/year/prerequisite/policy review
Returned for edits	Requested corrections and due date	Staff comments and reopen controls
Nominated / approved internally	Visible internal outcome	Send to provider or next workflow stage
Provider pending	External-step tracker	Record partner handoff
Accepted / waitlisted / declined	Final decision and policy next steps	Issue decision, conditions, and documentation
Committed	Pre-departure checklist appears	Activate orientation, forms, travel steps
Withdrawn	Archived but visible history	Retention and reporting only

Application composition

Applications should support:

- Personal details and emergency contact.
- Academic profile and proposed term.
- Essays and short responses.
- Passport/legal-name fields where truly needed.
- Transcript or recommendation requests.
- File uploads and per-document status.
- Conditional questions by program or country.
- Consent, conduct, and risk acknowledgments.
- Advisor messaging and deadline reminders.

A student dashboard should show checklist progress, latest staff messages, submission history, and outstanding items. Names and identity documents should be validated carefully because application guidance often depends on records matching official documents.[8]

Staff review workflow

```
Submission received
  → Completeness review
  → Eligibility check
  → Program-specific review
  → Advisor/staff scoring or notes
  → Nomination / decision
  → Student notification
  → Pre-departure activation
```

Important staff controls:

- Multi-reviewer queues.
- Internal notes hidden from students.
- Deadline overrides and reopen actions.
- Capacity management.
- Document validation.
- Decision templates.
- Audit history for every status change.
- Export to approved institutional systems.

Do not present automated checks as final admissions decisions. GPA thresholds and age/program requirements may exist, but human review and institutional policy still control the final outcome.[7]

Club event management and RSVP

Student-organization tools typically support event creation, RSVP, attendance tracking, and roster coordination. That should be a baseline for Semester clubs.[9] [1]

Event creation workflow

```
Draft event
  → Add schedule, location, description, media, capacity
  → Configure RSVP and check-in settings
  → Submit for approval, if required
  → Publish
  → Students RSVP / join waitlist
  → Event reminders
  → Check-in / attendance capture
  → Post-event recap and analytics
```

Event entity model

Entity	Required fields
Event	Organization, title, summary, description, category, visibility, host
Event session	Start/end, recurrence, location, virtual link, timezone
Capacity rule	Max seats, guest policy, waitlist enabled, check-in window
RSVP	User, response status, timestamp, attendance intent
Attendance record	User, check-in method, checked-in time, checked-out time
Event approval	Reviewer, policy state, notes, decision time
Event message	Reminder, update, cancellation, follow-up

RSVP states

```
Invited / Discoverable
  → Interested
  → Going
  → Waitlisted
  → Checked in
  → Attended / No-show / Cancelled
```

Workflow requirements

Students should be able to:

- Discover events from clubs, campus offices, and communities.
- RSVP, cancel, or join a waitlist.
- Add events to calendar.

- Receive reminders and location updates.
- Access tickets or QR check-in codes.
- See accessibility and accommodation details.
- Join temporary event discussion threads.

Club leaders should be able to:

- Create and edit events.
- Duplicate recurring formats.
- Cap attendance and manage waitlists.
- Use QR, manual, or self-check-in.
- Export attendance if permitted.
- Send reminders and post-event follow-ups.
- View participation summaries.

Attendance data must be scoped and purposeful. Engagement platforms often track participation, but institutions still need to define who can view, export, and act on those records. [10] [11]

Club roster workflow

```
Discover club
  → Follow / request to join / apply
  → Pending review
  → Member accepted
  → Role assignment
  → Participation and event attendance
  → Renewal / inactive / alumni
```

Roster functions should include:

- Active, pending, former, and alumni member states.
- Officer roles with start/end dates.
- Member notes and tags, if approved.
- Application-based or open membership.
- Controlled exports and audit logs.
- Leadership transition tools.

Marketplace listing creation and moderation

The marketplace should support listings for jobs, internships, study-abroad programs, services, events, student offers, and institutional opportunities. Student-engagement and community platforms often centralize these discovery surfaces, but Semester should add explicit verification and moderation flows. [11] [12]

Listing creation flow

```
Create draft
  → Complete listing details
  → Attach eligibility, deadlines, and contact methods
  → Submit for review
  → Approval / return for edits / rejection
  → Publish
  → Update / pause / fill / expire
  → Archive
```

Listing form requirements

Section	Required capabilities
Basics	Title, type, summary, full description, media, tags
Ownership	Provider, organization, contact, verification source
Timing	Open date, deadline, event/program dates, expiration
Eligibility	Major, year, GPA, work authorization, location, skills
Experience details	Paid/unpaid, credit-bearing, remote/on-site, hours
Safety/disclosures	External site warning, fees, travel risk, documentation
Actions	Apply in Semester, external apply, RSVP, join interest list
Moderation metadata	Reviewer notes, risk flags, trust score, audit history

Moderation workflow

```
Draft
  → Submitted
  → Triage
  → Verified / needs edits / escalated / rejected
  → Published
  → Reported by users
  → Re-review / pause / remove
```

Moderation rules

Use moderation layers:

- Automated triage for spam/risky patterns.
- Verification label assignment.
- Human review for sensitive categories.
- User reporting and appeal handling.
- Expiration and stale-listing sweeps.

- Evidence and audit preservation.

Important labels:

- Institution verified.
- Partner verified.
- Organization verified.
- Student-posted.
- External unverified link.

That distinction is critical so students can tell whether an opportunity is school-vetted or simply allowed on the platform.

Unified entity-relationship architecture

A single architecture can support all four domains by sharing users, organizations, media, and workflow services.

Shared foundation entities

Entity	Purpose
`users`	Identity and campus account link
`profiles`	Public-facing student/community profile
`roles`	Platform, organization, reviewer, advisor, moderator permissions
`files`	Uploaded documents, media, attachments
`notifications`	Feed, email, push, in-app alerts
`audit_events`	Immutable workflow and moderation history
`tags`	Cross-domain categorization
`preferences`	Privacy, notification, and personalization controls

Clubs and events entities

Entity	Purpose
`organizations`	Club or campus group record
`organization_roles`	Officers, advisors, reviewers
`memberships`	Member state history
`club_applications`	Membership application records
`club_application_answers`	Versioned responses
`events`	Event definitions
`event_sessions`	Date/time occurrences

Entity	Purpose
`rsvps`	RSVP status and timestamps
`attendance_records`	Check-in/check-out evidence

Marketplace entities

Entity	Purpose
`listing_providers`	Employer, office, club, or partner owner
`listings`	Marketplace opportunities
`listing_versions`	Published edits and change history
`listing_eligibility_rules`	Structured filters and requirements
`listing_actions`	Apply, RSVP, save, external click
`listing_reports`	User safety/moderation reports
`listing_reviews`	Approval and moderation decisions

Study-abroad entities

Entity	Purpose
`programs`	Study-abroad program catalog
`program_terms`	Term-specific dates, capacity, pricing
`program_applications`	Student applications
`application_documents`	Uploaded or requested files
`application_checklist_items`	Missing/completed steps
`application_reviews`	Reviewer decisions and notes
`program_decisions`	Acceptance, waitlist, decline, commit

Social/feed/messaging entities

Entity	Purpose
`communities`	Club, program, campus, or interest spaces
`posts`	Feed content
`post_media`	Images/video/file attachments
`comments`	Discussion threads
`reactions`	Likes and reaction types
`follows`	User-to-user, user-to-org, user-to-topic relationships

Entity	Purpose
`conversations`	DM, group, event, or organization chat
`conversation_members`	Membership and notification state
`messages`	Sent messages and edit/delete state
`reports`	Content or abuse reports
`moderation_cases`	Review, decisions, and appeals

Daily feed and messaging architecture

The daily feed should combine campus activity, opportunities, and communities without becoming a generic public social network.

Feed sources

- Official campus announcements.
- Club posts and events.
- Marketplace recommendations.
- Study-abroad and internship deadline reminders.
- Followed communities and saved-topic updates.
- Event chats and post-event recaps.
- Service reminders from approved offices.

Feed ranking principles

Rule	Requirement
Safety first	Emergency and critical institutional notices override ranking
Explicit interest first	Followed orgs, saved searches, and opted-in topics rank above inferred content
Explainability	Every recommendation should display a reason
Relevance limits	Repetitive or low-quality posts should be throttled
Sensitive-data exclusion	No ranking from grades, accommodations, or private application outcomes

FERPA and student-privacy guidance mean institutions should avoid using protected academic data casually in communication and online-service experiences.[4] [3]

Real-time messaging schema

A practical messaging model is:

```
conversations
  ├─ conversation_members
  ├─ messages
```

```
   ├─ message_reactions
   ├─ message_attachments
   ├─ message_reports
   └─ conversation_events
```

Key requirements:

- Direct messages, group chats, event chats, and organization channels.
- Message requests for non-connections.
- Block, mute, restrict, and report.
- Attachment scanning.
- Moderation review queues.
- Ephemeral typing/presence signals separate from retained records.
- Retention policies by conversation type.

Delivery roadmap

Phase 1

- Organization directory and club profiles.
- Event management and RSVP.
- Marketplace listings and filtering.
- Program directory and basic study-abroad applications.
- Shared moderation, notifications, and search.

Phase 2

- Club applications and role workflows.
- Study-abroad review queues and document tracking.
- Marketplace verification and provider moderation.
- Daily feed with follows and official posts.
- Messaging with reporting and blocking.

Phase 3

- Advanced recommendation engine with explanations.
- Internship trackers and offer workflows.
- Cross-domain analytics and engagement dashboards.
- Mobility features such as pre-departure cohorts and ambassador communities.
- Richer real-time collaboration and temporary event spaces.

The right implementation pattern is a modular platform with shared trust-and-safety services, not a single monolithic “student app” table. Existing engagement tools prove the value of rosters, events, and communications, while privacy rules make careful boundary design essential. [2] [1] [3]

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